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SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "MUSCADET"

approved by the order of 16 October 2019 published in the JORF of 19 October 2019

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Muscadet", initially recognised by the decree of 23 September 1937.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the term "sur lie" for wines meeting the production conditions fixed for this term in the present specification.

2° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the terms "primeur" or "nouveau" for wines meeting the production conditions fixed for these terms in the present specification.

3° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the geographical denomination "Val de Loire" according to the rules fixed for the use of this geographical denomination in the present specification.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Muscadet", whether or not supplemented by the terms "sur lie", "primeur" or "nouveau", is reserved for still white wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

a) – All the steps of the production take place in the geographical area approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 15 June 2017. The perimeter of this area, at the date of approval of the present specification by the competent national committee, encompasses the territory of the following communes or parts of communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2018:

Loire-Atlantique department: Aigrefeuille-sur-Maine, Ancenis, Basse-Goulaine, Le Bignon, La Boissière-du-Doré, Bouaye, Brains, Carquefou, Le Cellier, La Chapelle-Heulin, Château-Thébaud, La Chevrolière, Clisson, Corcoué-sur-Logne, Couffé, Divatte-sur-Loire, Geneston, Gétigné (part), Gorges, La Haie-Fouassière, Haute-Goulaine, Le Landreau, Legé (part), Ligné (part), La Limouzinière, Le Loroux-Bottereau, Maisdon-sur-Sèvre, Mauves-sur-Loire, Monnières, Montbert, Mouzillon, Oudon, Le Pallet, La Planche, Pont-Saint-Martin, Port-Saint-Père, La Regrippière, La Remaudière, Remouillé, Saint-Aignan-Grandlieu, Saint-Colomban, Sainte-Pazanne, Saint-Fiacre-sur- Maine, Saint-Géréon, Saint-Hilaire-de-Clisson, Saint-Julien-de-Concelles, Saint-Léger-les-Vignes, Saint-Lumine-de-Clisson, Saint-Lumine-de-Coutais, Saint-Mars-de-Coutais, Saint-Philbert-de-Grand- Lieu, Les Sorinières, Thouaré-sur-Loire, Vair-sur-Loire, Vallet, Vertou, Vieillevigne (part), Villeneuve-en-Retz for the sole territory of the delegated commune of Bourgneuf-en-Retz (part)

Maine-et-Loire department: Mauges-sur-Loire (for the sole territory of the delegated communes of La Chapelle-Saint-Florent et Saint-Florent-le-Vieil), Orée d'Anjou (pour le seul territoire des communes déléguées de Bouzillé, Champtoceaux, Drain, Landemont, Liré et La Varenne), Sèvremoine (for the sole territory of the delegated communes of Saint-Crespin-sur-Moine et Tillières)

Vendée department: Cugand (part), Rocheservière, Saint-Hilaire-de-Loulay (part), Saint- Philbert-de-Bouaine

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes retained in part the graphic documents establishing the boundaries of the geographical area thus approved. These cartographic documents may be consulted on the website of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 3 and 4 November 1994, 25 and 26 May 2000, 19 May 2011 and 20 June 2018. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, and for the vinification, elaboration, ageing and packaging of the wines liable to benefit from the term "sur lie", is made up of the territory of the following communes or parts of communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2018:

Loire-Atlantique department: La Bernerie-en-Retz, Bouguenais, Boussay, Chaumes-en-Retz, Chauvé, Cheix-en-Retz, Frossay, Gétigné (part), Legé (part), Ligné (part), Loireauxence (for the sole territory of the delegated communes of La Chapelle-Saint-Sauveur et Varades), Machecoul-Saint- Même, La Marne, Mésanger, Montrelais, Les Moutiers-en-Retz, Paulx, Le Pellerin, Pornic, Rezé, Rouans, Saint-Étienne-de-Mer-Morte, Saint-Hilaire-de-Chaléons, Saint-Père-en-Retz, Saint-Viaud, Touvois, Vieillevigne (part), Villeneuve-en-Retz (for the sole territory of the delegated communes of Bourgneuf-en-Retz (part) et Fresnay-en-Retz), Vue

Maine-et-Loire department: Beaupréau-en-Mauges (for the sole territory of the delegated communes of Beaupréau et Gesté), Ingrandes-Le Fresne sur Loire (for the sole territory of the delegated commune of Fresne-sur-Loire), Mauges-sur-Loire (for the sole territory of the delegated commune of Marillais), Montrevault-sur-Èvre (for the sole territory of the delegated communes of La Boissière-sur- Evre, La Chaussaire, Le Fief-Sauvin, Le Fuilet, Montrevault, Le Puiset-Doré, Saint-Pierre-Montlimart et Saint-Rémy-en-Mauges), Orée d'Anjou (for the sole territory of the delegated communes of Saint- Christophe-la-Couperie, Saint-Laurent-des-Autels et Saint-Sauveur-de-Landemont), Sèvremoine (for the sole territory of the delegated communes of Montfaucon-Montigné et Saint-Germain-sur-Moine)

Vendée department: Cugand (part), Montaigu, Saint-Étienne-du-Bois, Saint-Hilaire-de- Loulay (part)

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

The wines come from the melon B variety alone.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.

The vines present a minimum planting density at planting of 6,500 plants per hectare. The spacing between rows is less than or equal to 1.50 metre and the spacing between plants within the same row is between 0.90 metre and 1.10 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.

GENERAL PROVISIONS

The vines are pruned with a maximum of 14 free eyes (buds) per plant: - either by short spur pruning with a maximum of 5 spurs per plant; - or by single or double Guyot pruning. Pruning is completed before bud break, or stage 5 of the Eichhorn and Lorenz scale.

PARTICULAR PROVISIONS

The vines intended for the production of wines liable to benefit from the term "sur lie" are pruned with a maximum of 12 free eyes per plant. Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with 4 additional free eyes per plant, provided that at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to 14.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.
For vines pruned by single or double Guyot, the wire used for tying the long canes is fixed at a maximum height of 0.70 metre above the ground. For vines trained in the "raised single-plane trellising" mode, the lifting wires are positioned at a minimum height of 0.90 metre above the ground. The foliage height is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows when this spacing is less than or equal to 1.50 metre. The foliage height is measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, TERM	AVERAGE MAXIMUM LOAD PER PARCEL (kilograms per hectare)
Controlled designation of origin "Muscadet"	12,000
Term "sur lie"	10,000

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir, a plant cover is maintained on the headlands surrounding the vine parcels belonging to the delimited parcel area.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness. The date of the start of the harvest is fixed according to the provisions of Article D. 645-6 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes.
Grapes presenting a sugar content lower than the following may not be considered as being at proper ripeness:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, TERM	SUGAR RICHNESS OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)
Controlled designation of origin "Muscadet"	153
Term "sur lie"	161

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume.
The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, TERM	MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
Controlled designation of origin "Muscadet"	9.5 %
Term "sur lie"	10 %

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield and limit yield

The yield and the limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code are fixed at:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, TERM	YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)	LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)
Controlled designation of origin “Muscadet”	70	83
Term “sur lie”	55	66

2° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from: - parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July; - parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July; - parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, only from the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Analytical standards.
The wines present, after fermentation:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, TERM	MAXIMUM CONTENT OF FERMENTABLE SUGARS (glucose and fructose) (grams per litre)	TOTAL ACIDITY CONTENT (milliequivalents per litre)	MAXIMUM VOLATILE ACIDITY CONTENT (milliequivalents per litre)
Controlled designation of origin “Muscadet”	5	Between 61 and 112 for wines presenting a fermentable-sugars content (glucose and fructose) between 3 grams per litre and 5 grams per litre	10
Term “sur lie”	3		10

b) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.
Any thermal treatment of the harvest involving a temperature lower than -5 °C is prohibited. The wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 12 %. The wines are separated from their fine vinification lees at the latest on 31 July of the year following that of the harvest.

c) – Prohibited equipment.
Continuous presses with a helical screw are prohibited.

d) – Vat capacity.
The vinification vat capacity is at least equivalent to 1.4 times the product of the yield fixed in 1° of point VIII by the area in production in controlled designation of origin vinified in the cellar.

e) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment.
The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

The wines liable to benefit from the term “sur lie”: - are aged on their fine vinification lees from the end of the alcoholic fermentation and at least until 1 March of the year following that of the harvest; - spend only one winter in vat or in barrel and are still on their fine vinification lees at the moment of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) – For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - the analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis results are kept for a period of 12 months from the date of packaging.

b) – In order to preserve the characteristics arising from their mode of vinification and ageing, in particular their freshness, their aromatic complexity and the slight sparkle (perlant) due to their content of endogenous carbon dioxide, and so as to limit the rackings, the wines liable to benefit from the term “sur lie” are packaged in bottles in the vinification cellars between 1 March and 30 November of the year following that of the harvest.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a place suited to the storage of the packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to placing on the market for the consumer

The wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code. At the end of the ageing period, the wines benefiting from the term “sur lie” are placed on the market for the consumer from 8 March of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area presents a landscape shaped by the alternation of vines on the hillsides and knolls and of bocage meadows in the valleys, underlined in the most beautiful sites by the presence of ancient mills or of “folies nantaises” (holiday residences built in the 18th century by the aristocracy or the bourgeoisie on the outskirts of Nantes). The vine parcels are established essentially on the slopes formed by the Loire, the Sèvre and the Maine, the Goulaine marsh, the lake of Grandlieu and their tributaries, to the south and east of the town of Nantes. Close to the coasts of the Atlantic Ocean, the geographical area is connected both to Brittany by its history and to the Val de Loire by its geographical situation and extends over a part of the departments of Loire-Atlantique, Maine-et-Loire and Vendée.

The geographical area benefits from an oceanic climate characterised by the low annual variation of temperatures, owing to the proximity of important masses of water (ocean, Loire estuary, lake of Grandlieu, Goulaine marsh). The winter temperatures are particularly mild and the summers remain cool, with a ventilation ensured by the sea breezes. The precipitation is slightly deficient during the vegetative period of the vine, whence an important sunshine for this latitude, although the great tides of autumn are sometimes accompanied by heavy showers.

The geographical area presents a complex geology. In the Precambrian and the Primary era, orogenies led to the emplacement of plutonic rocks (granites, gabbros) and metamorphic rocks (gneiss, micaschists, eclogites, amphibolites). This bedrock is locally covered by tertiary sediments (clays, pebbly sands). The aeolian silts that were deposited on the region in the Quaternary era have generally been stripped away by erosion. Despite this geological diversity, the soils that develop on these formations are most often brown, sound, sandy and rich in stones. Reflecting the usages, the parcel area for the harvesting of the grapes strictly delimits the hillsides that present open landscapes, essentially or traditionally planted with vine, and the parcels presenting free-draining soils, endowed with a good aptitude for warming, with a limited water-retention capacity and a moderate chemical fertility.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The vineyard of the controlled designation of origin “Muscadet” is the heir of a viticultural tradition that goes back to the first centuries of our era. An oceanic port at the mouth of the Loire, Nantes asserts itself very early as an important crossroads for the dispatch of wines towards the British Isles and Northern Europe. Various writings attest to the nascent reputation of the wines in the Middle Ages. Progressively, especially under the impulse of the Dutch trade, the Nantes vineyard specialises in the production of white wines and brandies. The plantings of vines are then encouraged by taxation, the wines of Brittany being taxed at half those coming from upstream of the Loire.

The identity of the vineyard is truly forged with the development of the melon B variety. The first written traces of plantings of this “Burgundy plant” under the name “Muscadet” appear in the middle of the 17th century. After the rigorous winter of 1709, which destroyed a large part of the Nantes vineyard, the melon B variety, more resistant to frost, is replanted preferentially in the best situations of the region. The counter-revolutionary wars of 1793, in the course of which the vineyard is ravaged, then the phylloxera crisis from 1884, only delay its advent.

The reconstitution of the vineyard by grafting is the occasion to adapt the traditional cultivation usages to new techniques (planting in lines, Guyot pruning). From then on, the production know-how is well codified: adoption of the melon B variety alone, maintenance of a high planting density, control of the load of the vines and limitation of their yield, harvesting of the grapes at full ripeness. After a regulation by judicial means during the 1920s, these practices are enshrined by the recognition of the controlled designations of origin “Muscadet Sèvre et Maine” and “Muscadet Coteaux de la Loire”, in 1936, then “Muscadet” in 1937.

With a view to producing richer and more complex wines, the operators adopt a particular technical vinification route, the “méthode nantaise”, which consists in keeping the wines on their fine vinification lees for at least one winter without any racking, a know-how born of the habit that the producers had of keeping a barrel of their best wine on its lees to celebrate the family events of the following spring. This mode of ageing brings roundness and richness to the wines, by enrichment, in particular, in mannoproteins and other compounds arising from the autolysis of the yeast cell walls. Moreover, this method, which rests on the absence of handling of the wines and their maintenance under an atmosphere charged with carbon dioxide, by strongly limiting the phenomena of oxidation and the release of volatile compounds, makes it possible to preserve until spring and beyond the aromas formed during the alcoholic fermentation. The regulation specific to the traditional term “sur lie” is defined in 1977 and is reflected, since 1994, by the bottling of the wines in the vinification cellars themselves, so as to limit the rackings and the decanting of the wines.

In 2016, the vineyard of the controlled designation of origin “Muscadet” covers a little more than 8,000 hectares, exploited by about 600 producers.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

The wines of the controlled designation of origin “Muscadet” are white and still. They acquire their principal characteristics during their vinification and present fine and delicate aromas, most often in a fruity or floral register, and a gustatory balance globally dominated by freshness.

The wines benefiting from the term “sur lie” generally present a balance on the palate oriented more towards roundness, a more complex olfactory bouquet, and they may present a slight sparkle (perlant) due to the residual carbon dioxide formed during the alcoholic fermentation. In order to preserve their freshness, their aromatic richness and the endogenous carbon dioxide, they are protected from oxidation during their ageing. Their carbon dioxide content being too high for a packaging in flexible containers, they are packaged in bottles and require particular care at packaging.

3° – Causal interactions

“If the soil of the Loire-Inférieure is excellent, its climate is marvellous”, writes Jules GUYOT in his “Study of the vineyards of France” (Volume II, Paris, 1876). Indeed, the geographical area benefits from the conjunction between soils propitious to viticulture and a climate that favours the aromatic expression of the white varieties. Thus, the coarse texture of the soils ensures an early start of the vine cycle and limits its vigour. The mildness of the winters accentuates this earliness, the summer sunshine and the sea winds protecting the vegetation from sanitary attacks. The soils of the geographical area moreover ensure a

moderate and regular water supply to the vine, a guarantee of a good ripeness, thanks to their reduced water reserve and to their fracturing, which allows a rooting of the plants in depth. Finally, the moderation of the summer temperatures is ideal for preserving the freshness and the delicate aromas that are expressed in the wines coming from the melon B variety.

Heirs of an ancient viticultural history, the producers of the geographical area have for more than three centuries given priority to the cultivation of this unique and rare melon B variety on the best hillsides. They have optimised the viticultural practices to ensure the harvesting of sound and ripe grapes, with a subtle balance of the richness / acidity ratio that is found again in the wines. Vinified in accordance with local usages, the wines are often aged on their fine vinification lees, without any racking, which allows the odorous molecules formed during fermentation to be expressed in the wines. Thanks to the mildness of the winter temperatures of the geographical area, which favour the exchanges with the lees, the wines continue to improve during their ageing and reveal a greater richness on the palate from the following spring. Packaged in bottle during the year following that of the harvest, the wines of the controlled designation of origin supplemented with the term “sur lie” gain in complexity, while retaining their characteristic freshness, sustained by a slight sparkle provoked by the residual carbon dioxide formed during vinification. To keep the benefit of this ageing and avoid any oxidation, the operators have acquired a particular know-how at the packaging of the wines, by carrying out a bottling directly in the vinification cellars. This traditional practice, which minimises the handling of the products, is perfectly suited to preserving the delicate odorous compounds of the wines.

The wines of the controlled designation of origin “Muscadet” became essential from the middle of the 20th century in France, where their spontaneous notoriety and their rate of market penetration currently place them in second position among the white wines. During the 1980s, exportation developed anew, to the point of representing nearly 40 % of the volumes marketed. Tourism plays an important role in this success thanks to the proximity of the coast and the association of the wines with seafood and fish. By its area in production, this vineyard is, in 2010, one of the largest white-wine vineyards in the world planted with a single variety.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Delimited parcel area

The parcels planted with vine at the date of 19 May 2011, excluded from the delimited parcel area of the controlled designation of origin, benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2025 harvest inclusive, subject to meeting the other provisions of the present specification.

2° – Oenological practices and physical treatments

On a transitional basis, and until the 2019 harvest inclusive, the wines may be kept on their fine vinification lees after 31 July of the year following that of the harvest.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Muscadet” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The dimensions of the characters of the terms “sur lie”, “primeur” or “nouveau” and of the geographical denomination “Val de Loire” are less than or equal, both in height and in width or in thickness, to those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The wines benefiting from the terms “sur lie”, “primeur” or “nouveau” are presented with the indication of the vintage.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1° – Prior declaration of parcel allocation

To benefit from the term “sur lie”, each operator declares, to the defence and management body, the list of the parcels allocated to this production, before 1 February preceding the harvest. This declaration specifies: - the name and address of the operator; - its EVV or SIRET number; - for each allocated parcel, the cadastral reference and the area in production. This declaration is renewable by tacit renewal.

2° – Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least 15 days before the placing into circulation of the wines, at the latest on 31 December of the year of harvest. This declaration specifies: - the name and address of the applicant; - its EVV or SIRET number; - the controlled designation of origin claimed and, where applicable, the term “sur lie”, “primeur” or “nouveau”; - the volume of wine claimed; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration or of the production declaration.

The buyers of grapes and musts send to the defence and management body an extract of their stock accounts, at least 15 days before any bulk marketing of the wines, and at the latest on 31 December of the year of harvest.

3° – Prior declaration of transaction or of placing on the market for the consumer of a non-packaged wine

Every operator intending a lot of non-packaged wine, benefiting from the controlled designation of origin, for a transaction or a placing on the market for the consumer declares it, to the approved control body, within a time limit of 10 working days before the first transaction of the first lot of the year concerned or the first placing on the market for the consumer of the wine. This declaration specifies: - the identity of the operator; - its EVV or SIRET number; - the identification of the lot and of the container(s); - the forecast volume of wine concerned; - the foreseeable date of transaction or of placing on the market for the consumer.

4° – Prior declaration of packaging

Every operator wishing to package a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it, to the approved control body, within a time limit of 10 working days before the first packaging. This declaration specifies: - the identity of the operator; - its EVV or SIRET number; - the identification of the lot and of the container(s); - the forecast volume of wine concerned; - the foreseeable date of packaging.

5° – Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it, to the approved control body, within a time limit of at least 10 working days before the dispatch.

6° – Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it, to the defence and management body and to the approved control body, at the latest on 15 December following this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

1° – Viticultural register

Every operator exploiting vines fit for the production of the controlled designation of origin fills in, before 1 June of the year of harvest, a register indicating the parcels on which it renounces production in controlled designation of origin and does not wish to apply the production conditions of the vineyard of the controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body may ask the operators to transmit a copy of this register.

2° – Cellar registers

a) – Every operator vinifying, elaborating, ageing or storing wines of the controlled designation of origin keeps up to date a cellar plan making it possible in particular to identify the number, the designation, the type and the capacity of the wine containers.

b) – Every operator vinifying wines of the controlled designation of origin keeps up to date a vinification register indicating for each container or lot: - the identification of the container or of the lot; - the volume of the container or of the lot; - the date of filling of the container(s); - the claim objective (controlled designation of origin, term); - the sugar richness before the start of the alcoholic fermentation; - the natural alcoholic strength by volume of the lot; - the date of separation of the wine from its fine vinification lees.

c) – Every operator packaging wines of the controlled designation of origin keeps up to date a packaging register indicating for each lot: - the identification of the container(s) of origin of the lot; - the volume of the lot (expressed in hectolitres or in number of bottles); - the marketing objective (controlled designation of origin, term); - the date of packaging; - the number of the packaged lot. The downgradings appear on this register.

d) – Every operator marketing non-packaged wines of the controlled designation of origin, where applicable within the framework of a bottling-at-the-property contract, keeps up to date a marketing register indicating for each lot: - the identification of the container(s) of origin of the lot; - the volume of the lot (expressed in hectolitres or in number of bottles); - the marketing objective (controlled designation of origin, term); - the date of dispatch; - the reference of the recipient and, where applicable, the interprofessional contract number. The downgradings appear on this register.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited parcel area.	Documentary check and check in the field.
A2 – Production potential (grape varieties, entry into production of young vines, planting density).	Documentary check and check in the field.
A3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging and storage (place of vinification and elaboration of the wines).	Documentary check and on-site check.
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard (pruning, average maximum load per parcel, cultivation condition of the vine).	Check in the field.
B2 – Ripeness of the grapes.	Documentary check and check in the field.
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage (monitoring of the vinification and ageing rules, condition of upkeep of the cellar and the equipment).	Documentary check and on-site check.
B4 – Yield (harvest declaration and claim declaration).	Documentary check.
B5 – Date of separation of the wines from their fine vinification lees.	Documentary check.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines intended for a transaction or a placing on the market for the consumer.	Analytical and organoleptic check.
Packaged wines.	Analytical and organoleptic check.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic check of all the lots.

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
Fax: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.04
Email: info@inao.gouv.fr

The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, under the authority of the INAO, on the basis of an approved inspection plan.

The inspection plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.